

Saori Morita

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🌐 <https://sao-m1023lily.github.io/myprofile/>

Research Interests

- 📖 Neurolinguistics, Speech and Hearing Sciences
- 📖 Computational Linguistics, Psycholinguistics, Natural Language Processing

Education

- 2025.03 – ···· 📖 **Ph.D. student, The University of Tokyo** in Language and Information Sciences, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences.
- 2023.04 – 2025.03 📖 **M.A. The University of Tokyo** in Language and Information Sciences, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences.
Thesis title: *Simulating Aphasic Word Production with Large Language Models*.
- 2019.04 – 2023.03 📖 **B.A. Nagoya University of Foreign Studies** in English Communication, Department of British and American Studies.
Thesis title: *Comparative Adjectives in Aphasia: Evidence from the Adler Aphasia Center Corpus*.

Research Experiences

- 2025.04 – 2028.03 📖 Research Fellow (DC1)
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)
- 2026.03 – 2026.09 📖 J1 Visiting Scholar
University of California, Irvine, Department of Cognitive Sciences
- 2025.07 – 2026.02 📖 Researcher (Part-time)
Advanced Language Science (E3P) Research Center, National Institute for Japanese Language and Linguistics
- 2025.06 – 2026.03 📖 Research Assistant
Large Language Model Research and Development Center, National Institute of Informatics (NII)

Publications

Conference Proceedings

- 1 S. Morita, Y. Harada, and Y. Oseki, “Do aphasia neurons exist in large language models?” In *Proceedings of the 32nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing*, 2026.
- 2 S. Morita, Y. Harada, T. Naoe, T. Okimura, and Y. Oseki, “Simulating semantic paraphasia with japanese large language models,” in *The 63rd Annual Meeting of The Academy of Aphasia*, Oct. 2025, pp. 333–335.
- 3 S. Morita, Y. Harada, T. Naoe, T. Okimura, and Y. Oseki, “Simulating word production in aphasia using large language models,” in *Proceedings of the 31st Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing*, Mar. 2025, pp. 1369–1374.
- 4 Y. Harada, A. Maeda, S. Morita, and Y. Oseki, “Understanding large language models via neuroscience-inspired synaptic pruning,” in *Proceedings of the 30th Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing*, Mar. 2024, pp. 763–767.

- 5 T. Naoe et al., “Simulating thought disorder in psychiatric disorders by pruning large language models,” in *Proceedings of the 30th Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing*, Mar. 2024, pp. 243–248.
- 6 S. Morita and Y. Oseki, “An analysis of comparative adjectives error using a corpus of speakers with broca’s and wernicke’s aphasia,” in *Proceedings of the 167th Meeting of the Linguistic Society of Japan*, Nov. 2023, pp. 398–404.

Talks

- 1 S. Morita, *Speech characteristics of individuals with aphasia and a modeling for aphasia informed by research in computational psychiatry*, Encouraging Workshop on Formal Linguistics (EWFL10), Mar. 2024.

Skills

International Skills

Languages	Japanese (Native), English (Proficient), Korean (Intermediate reading, currently studying), Mandarin Chinese (Beginner, actively learning).
Certifications	TOEIC 805, TOEFL ibt 80, Eiken(Test in Practical English Proficiency) Grade Pre-1.
Cultural Experience	One-month intensive English summer program The University of Toronto.

Technical Skills

Coding	Python, R, L ^A T _E X, ...
Web Dev	HTML

Awards

- 2024 Special Committee Award
Taiga Naoe, Yuto Harada, Alyssa Maeda, Saori Morita, Hironobu Nakamura, Yohei Oseki, Tsukasa Okimura.
The 30th Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2024).
(top 4% of 599 submissions)

Grants and Fellowship

- Apr 2025 – Mar 2028 JSPS Doctoral Course Research Fellowship (DC1)
"Analyzing Speech Patterns in Aphasia through Large Language Model Simulation." Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS).
(FY2025; acceptance rate: 14%, Humanities category, 62/438 applicants)

Memberships

- 2024.3 – ... The Linguistic Society of Japan (LSJ)
2023.6 – ... The Association for Natural Language Processing

Academic Service

Conference Volunteer Staff

- 2023.11  The 41st Annual Conference of The English Linguistic Society of Japan.
The University of Tokyo.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

- 2023 -  ALESS (Active Learning of English for Science Students) / ALESA (Active Learning of English for Students of the Arts) / FLOW (Fluency-oriented workshop)
Center for Academic Writing at Komaba (CAWK), The University of Tokyo.
- 2025.9  Special NLP Seminar: Natural Language Processing and Deep Learning for Linguistic Analysis. The Association for Natural Language Processing, The University of Tokyo.

Early Research Activities

- 2016  Chiba University President's Award (1st out of 337 entries; 2nd overall).
Saori Morita. The 10th High School Students' Science Research Presentation.
- 2017  Encouragement Award (selected among top 20 of 100 entries).
Saori Morita, Fumika Demachi, Shizuka Hoshi. 13th Physical Society of Japan Junior Session.